1. CISSP — All 8 domains

No.	Official CISSP domain	What it covers
1	Security and Risk Management	Security governance, risk management, compliance, ethics, business continuity and security awareness
2	Asset Security	Data classification, ownership, handling, retention, privacy and secure disposal
3	Security Architecture and Engineering	Security design principles, cryptography, secure architecture, infrastructure and physical security
4	Communication and Network Security	Network architecture, secure protocols, segmentation, network defense and communications security
5	Identity and Access Management (IAM)	Authentication, authorization, identity lifecycle, SSO, MFA and access control
6	Security Assessment and Testing	Security testing, vulnerability assessment, penetration testing, audits and security control validation
7	Security Operations	Incident response, investigations, logging, monitoring, disaster recovery and operational security
8	Software Development Security	Secure SDLC, application security, software vulnerabilities, testing and development security practices

These are the official domain names. The job designations below are common industry roles mapped to those domains, not official CISSP job titles.

2. CISSP domains mapped to job roles, designations and responsibilities

The following table maps each domain to common job titles and the work professionals typically perform. One designation can span multiple domains.

CISSP domain	Common job roles / designations	Key roles and responsibilities
1. Security and Risk Management	GRC Analyst, GRC Manager, Information Security Manager, Security Compliance Analyst, Risk Manager, CISO	Define security policies, conduct risk assessments, manage compliance, perform audits, maintain risk registers, oversee business continuity and security governance.
2. Asset Security	Data Security Engineer, Data Protection Analyst, Data Governance Manager, Data Privacy Specialist, DLP Engineer	Classify data, define data ownership, implement encryption and DLP, manage data retention and disposal, protect sensitive information and support privacy requirements.
3. Security Architecture and Engineering	Security Architect, Principal Security Engineer, Cloud Security Architect, Enterprise	Design secure architectures, apply Zero Trust and defense in depth, select security controls, implement cryptography, evaluate technical risks

	Security Architect, Security Engineering Manager	and establish enterprise security patterns.
4. Communication and Network Security	Network Security Engineer, Network Security Architect, Firewall Engineer, Security Infrastructure Engineer, SASE Engineer	Design network segmentation, manage firewalls and VPNs, secure routing and communications, configure IDS/IPS, analyze network traffic and protect hybrid connectivity.
5. Identity and Access Management (IAM)	IAM Engineer, IAM Architect, IGA Engineer, PAM Engineer, Identity Security Architect, Access Management Lead	Implement SSO, MFA, RBAC, identity lifecycle management, access reviews, privileged access management, federation and least-privilege controls.
6. Security Assessment and Testing	Penetration Tester, Vulnerability Management Engineer, Security Assessment Analyst, Application Security Tester, Security Auditor, Red Team Engineer	Conduct penetration tests, vulnerability scans, security control assessments, application testing, audit evidence collection, remediation tracking and retesting.
7. Security Operations	SOC Analyst L1/L2/L3, Incident Responder, Threat Hunter, DFIR Analyst, SIEM Engineer, Security Operations Manager	Monitor security events, investigate alerts, respond to incidents, conduct forensic analysis, manage security logs, detect threats, maintain operational resilience and support disaster recovery.
8. Software Development Security	Application Security Engineer, Product Security Engineer, DevSecOps Engineer, Software Security Architect, Product Security Manager	Integrate security into SDLC and CI/CD, perform SAST/DAST/SCA, review code, secure APIs, manage software supply-chain risks and establish secure coding standards.

Official domain names and examination weights are based on the ISC2 CISSP exam outline effective April 15, 2024. Job titles and responsibilities are representative industry mappings.

3. Seniority and career designations

The same CISSP domain knowledge can support different career levels.

Career level	Example designations	Typical responsibility
Entry level	Security Analyst, SOC Analyst L1, Junior IAM Engineer	Monitor, investigate, configure, document and escalate.
Mid-level	Security Engineer, GRC Analyst, IAM Engineer, Vulnerability Analyst	Implement controls, conduct assessments, troubleshoot and remediate findings.
Senior level	Senior Security Engineer, Senior IAM Engineer, Senior Penetration Tester	Own technical workstreams, handle complex investigations and lead implementation.
Lead level	Security Technical Lead, IAM Lead, SOC Lead, GRC Lead	Set technical direction, review designs, mentor teams and coordinate delivery.

Architect level	Security Architect, Cloud Security Architect, IAM Architect, Enterprise Security Architect	Define architectures, standards, security patterns and technology decisions.
Principal / Staff level	Principal Security Engineer, Staff Security Engineer, Principal Identity Security Engineer	Solve cross-team security problems, establish enterprise controls and influence strategic technical decisions.
Management level	Security Engineering Manager, Director of Security, Head of Security	Manage people, budgets, programs, risks and security outcomes.
Executive level	CISO, Deputy CISO, Chief Security Architect	Own or oversee enterprise security strategy, risk posture, governance and executive reporting.

Important: CISSP is a certification, not a job designation. Earning it does not automatically qualify someone for an architect, principal or executive position; experience, technical capability, leadership and the employer's requirements matter.

4. Which domains align with your main cybersecurity career tracks?

Given your focus on cloud security, IAM/IGA/PAM, GRC and application security, these are the closest domain alignments.

Career track	Primary CISSP domains	Potential target designations
Cloud Security	3, 4, 7, 1	Cloud Security Engineer, Principal Cloud Security Engineer, Cloud Security Architect
IAM / IGA / PAM	5, 3, 1, 7	IAM Architect, Principal Identity Security Engineer, IGA Architect, PAM Engineer
GRC and Compliance	1, 2, 6, 7	GRC Manager, Cyber Risk Manager, Security Compliance Lead
Network Security	4, 3, 6, 7	Network Security Architect, Senior Network Security Engineer
Penetration Testing	6, 4, 3, 7	Penetration Tester, Senior Security Consultant, Red Team Engineer
SOC / DFIR	7, 4, 6, 1	SOC Lead, Incident Response Lead, DFIR Analyst, Threat Hunter
Application Security / DevSecOps	8, 3, 6, 7	Application Security Engineer, Product Security Architect, DevSecOps Lead
Enterprise Security Architecture	3, 1, 4, 5, 7	Enterprise Security Architect, Principal Security Architect, Chief Security Architect